embark on this journey, the political climate was characterized by hopelessness for the Opposition. There were cocky assertions of ‘New India’ being brought to life with the support of corporate capital, and unending religious hatred and subversion of elected governments through the misuse of institutions. The Yatra did not only provide an ideological counter, but through its successful completion, demonstrated that the idea of India that our founders had was not only alive, but still had enormous appeal among the common masses of our country. It was nurtured by a political force that was willing to fight for it. And lastly, it had a leader in Rahul Gandhi, who was willing to take unwavering moral and ideological positions to defend that idea.

It is said that Vietnam won the war against the United States of America despite being no match for them technologically and financially because it had something much more valuable than bombs and money—it had something to fight for. The Bharat Jodo Yatra gave millions of Indians exactly that—an idea of India that is worth fighting for.